

Cheap Yellow Chrysanthemums

I sit poised upon this most back-breaking of devices
somehow made for sitting, with your head blanketing
half of my lap. An omnipresent hum from above bear-
hugs my brain, never letting go while still providing
the needed clarity. Frantic baby blue sentries fly in and

out laughing at each other, numb to the lows, despair
balancing hope. Rigidly gray figures wear masks that
frown, some that cry, and a few that wince, while yours
is one of the few that spells peace and mine is colored
confusion. Your home is a curious one quite unfamiliar

to me and I'm sure that this place is not one lined with
security, or painted with reassurance, so maybe your iron-
clad will is not a farce after all. The bellyache of the
waiting room, the panic of the testing room, and the pit of
the final room do not calm the storm that brews at the

thought of your mothers rath reigning down were she to
find me ignoring a pair of racoon eyes sunken into yellow
or that swollen dry taste found flat on your tongue.

Incessant, unrelenting, and diligent is the beep of reality
that thumps on your dream of a perfect Valentines Day.
As my mind's bailiff, I keep receiving orders to release these

awful prisoners since one frame of mind has found them innocent
on all charges. But I'm afraid. I'm reeeaaaal afraid, and I feel like

I've never felt that these one's should ever be free. Single
handedly wrestling my heart down, out, and around, I barely
stand victorious over those felony words "I", "love", and "you."
With your IV gingerly taped and your hair tickling my
ear, I hope I provide sanctuary, but I'll never really know.

Baby blue again, this time with latex, returns as the dealer
pulling you up and running away. We wait. We smile. We blow
a kiss or two and three. *"Can you imagine what you would do
if I turned to you and said '____, I'm in love with you.' You
would run out those doors so fast, I would never see you again."*

Wouldn't that be perfect?

Because I don't know what I'd do, but I sure

wouldn't

run.